

6.8 Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

ایم وی پی (Minimum Viable Product) کسی پراڈکٹ کا سب سے سادہ مگر کام کرنے والا ورژن ہے جس میں صرف ضروری خصوصیات ہوتی ہیں۔

CS XII

Chapter 6: Entrepreneurship in the Digital Age

Lecture 09 of 16

★ Golden

6.8 Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

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LEARN IT

A **Minimum Viable Product (MVP)** is the **simplest working version** of a product. It includes **only the most important features** needed to **test the idea with real users**.

- **Minimum:** it has only the **essential** features. No extras.
- **Viable:** it is **usable enough** to actually solve the main problem. ("Viable" means able to work successfully.)

An MVP is **not the final product**. It is also **not only a drawing**. It is a **small working version** used to test whether users actually need the solution.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Example from the source: canteen app.

Complete canteen app (final product)	Canteen MVP
Login, online payment, delivery tracking, discount offers...	A simple Google Form where students select snacks before break.

Step-by-step: how to cut a big idea down to an MVP.

1. List all features you dream of: login, payment, delivery tracking, discounts.
2. Ask of each one: "Without this, can a student still pre-order a snack?"
3. Login? Not needed; the student can type name and class. Payment? Not needed; pay at the counter. Delivery tracking? Not needed; students collect. Discounts? Not needed.
4. What is left is the core: **choose snack + name + class**. A Google Form does this for free.

That form is **minimum** (no extras) and **viable** (students really can pre-order with it).

REMEMBER IT

Simple meaning. An MVP answers: "**Will people actually use this solution?**" It tests **real use and behaviour**, not only the visual design.

Analogy: before opening a full restaurant, a cook in Hyderabad sells biryani from home to office workers for two weeks. If people keep ordering, the idea is worth growing. That home kitchen is the MVP.

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake 1: Calling a paper sketch an MVP. **Fix:** A sketch is a prototype. An MVP must **work** and be used by **real users**.

Mistake 2: Thinking MVP means a low-quality or broken product. **Fix:** It is small but **viable**; it must genuinely solve the main problem.

اردو میں سمجھیں

ایم وی پی (Minimum Viable Product) کسی پراڈکٹ کا سب سے سادہ مگر کام کرنے والا ورژن ہے جس میں صرف ضروری خصوصیات ہوتی ہیں۔ "منیمم" کا مطلب ہے صرف ضروری چیزیں، اور "وائیل" کا مطلب ہے کہ وہ اصل مسئلہ حل کرنے کے قابل ہو۔ یہ حتمی پراڈکٹ نہیں بلکہ یہ جانچنے کا ذریعہ ہے کہ کیا لوگ واقعی اسے استعمال کریں گے، جیسے کینٹین کے لیے ایک سادہ گوگل فارم۔

EXAM TIP

Typical questions: "What is an MVP? Explain the words Minimum and Viable" and "Give an example of an MVP." Write the full form, the definition (simplest working version, only most important features, test with real users), explain both words, state that it is neither the final product nor only a drawing, and give the canteen Google Form example.

Mention the key question: "Will people actually use this solution?"

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Write the full form of MVP.
2. What does "Viable" mean in MVP?
3. What question does an MVP answer?

Answers: 1. Minimum Viable Product. 2. Usable enough to actually solve the main problem. 3. "Will people actually use this solution?"

Extra board practice

These MCQs and questions are extra to the textbook. Close the notes, attempt them, then open the key.

MCQ 1. An MVP is:

- a. The simplest working version that can test the riskiest assumption
- b. A paper sketch only
- c. The full app with every feature
- d. A logo

MCQ 2. Working means:

- a. Real users can get the core value (even if ugly/manual)
- b. It compiles Hello World
- c. It has 40 screens
- d. It has AI always

MCQ 3. This is ★: contrast with prototype in the next lecture, but here emphasise:

- a. Learning from a real offer
- b. Colours
- c. NAND
- d. OSI

MCQ 4. A WhatsApp group that actually takes canteen orders is:

- a. Closer to MVP than a Figma only
- b. Not digital
- c. A stack
- d. A pie

MCQ 5. Building extra features first is:

- a. The usual MVP failure
- b. Required
- c. Agile gold always
- d. HCI gold always

MCQ 6. The goal is to learn:

- a. Whether people use/pay, cheaply
- b. Whether the CEO likes purple
- c. Whether Big O is n^2
- d. Whether ER is 3NF

Extra short questions

1. Define MVP from the book.
2. What "viable" means.
3. What "minimum" means.
4. One example.

Extra long question

1. Design an MVP for "notes exchange" that you could run next week without an app store. List in/out features and the learning question. ★ Golden.

Extra answer key

MCQs: 1. A 2. A 3. A 4. A 5. A 6. A

Short

1. Minimum Viable Product: simplest working version with only essential features, used to learn from real users.
2. Someone can complete the core job (order food, book notes).
3. Strip extras (reviews, AI, dark mode) until the core is tested.
4. Google Form + JazzCash + pickup window, before an app.

Long

1. In: list of notes, request, pickup. Out: chat, ratings, payments maybe later. Question: will 20 students actually exchange? How you measure.

Next lecture: 6.9 Difference between Prototype and MVP